09. Midnight Carnival

Eclipse Cup · upgrade blueprint · src/kart/tracks/carnival.ts

Where it is now

3.2 km: midway, fun house, coaster lift hill and camelback, boosted launch over the flume pond or the flume, big top, carousel. Lap 2 fireworks and dodgems; last lap coaster car.

What is wrong

The coaster is just a raised road with a hill. The rides are scenery.

Core mechanic

A real coaster. On the coaster the kart locks on to the track: loops, a corkscrew and a big drop where you control only speed and lean. Lean wrong in a bend and you are thrown off and rescued.

Signature moments

- The coaster: lift hill, drop, full loop, corkscrew.
- The bumper-car arena: an open floor where cars bounce off each other and the walls.
- The hall of mirrors: false routes and real ones.
- The log flume, driven on the water channel.

Layout changes

- Coaster as a locked-on section of about 500 m.
- Add the bumper-car arena as an open section.
- Keep the midway and big top.

Lap changes

- Lap 2: fireworks; the dodgems spill out.
- Last lap: the coaster runs faster and its car chases you.

Engine work needed

- Locked-on rails with loops and corkscrews (full 3D orientation).
- Bouncy collisions in the arena.

Rivals

- Rivals lean correctly on the coaster.
- Rivals bump in the arena.

Done when

- Laps of 50-60 s for a good driver; all 3-lap test races finish with no errors.
- Rivals use every route and the core mechanic, with no more than 2 rival falls per race.
- The core mechanic is in play for at least half the lap, not just one set piece.
- A blind test: a screenshot or a 10-second clip of this track could not be mistaken for any other track.
- Item rows are never on the start line; nothing solid blocks a road by accident.